PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #72 · SUBSTANCE ABUSE

"I need it to get through the day. I can't cope without it."

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Where it often comes from

Many people start using because a day was too heavy: pain, fear, grief, a mind that would not quiet, a life that asked for more than they had. The relief was real. The lie comes later, when the relief is renamed the only way to cope. "I can't get through the day without it." That sentence feels like a fact because the day is hard and the other tools are rusty. It is still a belief, not a life sentence. You are allowed to need help learning another way. You are also allowed to be honest that stopping may need a doctor, not a burst of willpower. If you want help, call the SAMHSA National Helpline at 1-800-662-4357. Do not try to stop or withdraw on your own if that could make you sick. A doctor can help you do it safely, and a counselor can walk with you. Needing that help is not a failure.

What Scripture teaches

God's grace is sufficient, and His power is made perfect in weakness. That is not a slogan that says "cope harder." It says you do not have to be strong enough by yourself. "Do not fear, for I am with you. I will strengthen you and help you." Help comes from the Lord. Jesus invites the weary to come and rest. You can approach Him for mercy in a time of need. None of these verses shame you for having used something to get through. They say it is not your only help.

> *"But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me"* (2 Corinthians 12:9).

Also see

> "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness" (Isaiah 41:10).

> "I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth" (Psalm 121:1–2).

> "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest" (Matthew 11:28).

> "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need" (Hebrews 4:16).

Common self-statements

- I cannot get through a normal day without it.
- Other people cope. I am the one who cannot.
- If I do not use, I will fall apart, so I have no choice.
- God expects me to white-knuckle this.
- Asking for another way means I am weak.
- Nothing a counselor says will work on a real day.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: If this has been your way to cope, no other way can exist.
- Fortune telling: Deciding a day without it will certainly destroy you.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unable and calling the feeling a permanent fact.

- Discounting the positive: Ignoring every hour you have gotten through another way.

Challenging questions

- What did this help me survive, and what is it costing me now?
- Have I ever gotten through a hard hour another way, even a small one?
- Am I calling "I have not learned another way yet" the same thing as "no other way exists"?
- Who could help me build one other option?
- What would be unsafe about stopping on my own?
- What does "I will help you" mean on a day I want to use?

Truth summary

> I have used this to get through the day, and it is not my only help. God is with me, and I can learn another way with a doctor and a counselor.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Help
- Peace
- God, All Powerful
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Weak/Tired
- Prayer

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from "The Mentally Healthy Christian" (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
You can be held while you learn another way to get through the day.

Worn — Tenth Avenue North
Being worn down is a reason to ask for help, not a reason this is your only option.

Same Power — Jeremy Camp
God's strength is for the hour you are actually in.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
His faithfulness does not run out on a hard day.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I need it to get through the day. I can't cope without it."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I need it to get through the day. I can't cope without it." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did this help me survive, and what is it costing me now?
- ☐ Have I ever gotten through a hard hour another way, even a small one?
- ☐ Am I calling "I have not learned another way yet" the same thing as "no other way exists"?
- ☐ Who could help me build one other option?
- ☐ What would be unsafe about stopping on my own?
- ☐ What does "I will help you" mean on a day I want to use?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I have used this to get through the day, and it is not my only help. God is with me, and I can learn another way with a doctor and a counselor.
- ☐ The day is hard, and that is not the same as "nothing else will ever help."
- ☐ Relief I reached for does not have to be my only plan.
- ☐ God's strength shows up in weakness.
- ☐ I can ask for help before I am out of other ideas.
- ☐ A doctor can help me change this safely.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."
- ☐ Isaiah 41:10
  "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness."
- ☐ Psalm 121:1–2
  "I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth."

A verse I found myself:

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When the day felt impossible without it: Each day, write down one moment when using felt like the only way to cope. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 12:9 becomes: "James can write: "God's grace is enough for this day. This is not my only help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Help" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. For help with substance use, call 1-800-662-4357, and talk with a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick.

- [ ] Name one other help you could try in the next hard hour: a person, a walk, a prayer, a meeting, or a call to 1-800-662-4357.
- [ ] Talk with a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick. Do not turn this card into a plan to quit alone tonight.
- [ ] Tell your counselor what the day feels like without it. Let them help you make the next hour smaller.
- [ ] Read Isaiah 41:10 when the sentence "I can't cope" starts.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I need it to get through the day. I can't cope without it.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	An hour I got through another way
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I need it to get through the day. I can't cope without it~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have believed I cannot get through the day without this. Your grace is sufficient in my weakness. Give me a doctor, a counselor, and one other way to cope. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.